cohesion. Defending ‘Islamic’ Pakistan against ‘Hindu’ India became a national narrative.

Despite the sacrifices made in hopes of creating a home for South Asia’s Muslims, Pakistan ‘found in independence neither the peace, nor the security, nor the freedom of spirit that would enable it either to live in harmony with India, or ignore it.’[12] Instead, since its inception, the country has been forced to confront a more powerful external enemy. Partition left many Indians bitter and convinced the Pakistani experiment would fail. In turn, Pakistan’s new rulers took a reflexively defensive posture, convinced of Indian intentions to re-conquer their new country. The two countries quickly found themselves at war over Kashmir, which compounded the enmity and distrust each had for the other.

In 1971, after twenty-four years of physical separation, East Pakistan cleaved itself politically from Pakistan and Bangladesh was formed. Making matters worse, India helped wield the knife by joining the battle on Bangladesh’s side. Although India provided military support, the causes of this rupture were rooted in West Pakistan’s refusal to allow East Pakistan a major role in governing the country despite the fact that it contained a majority of the citizenry.[13] Pakistani efforts to promote cohesion became more zealous and more militant after the loss of Bangladesh, which robbed the country of its justification as a homeland for South Asian Muslims. In response even greater emphasis was placed on Pakistan’s Islamic heritage, and the concept of ‘Islamic’ Pakistan against ‘Hindu’ India was reinforced through constant propaganda and the educational system.[14] A nationally representative survey conducted in 2009 found that while better-educated Pakistanis were less likely to support the Taliban than their less-educated peers, the same did not hold true for those militant outfits fighting in Indian-administered Kashmir. The reason, according to those who conducted this research, is the presence of strong anti-Indian sentiment and support for the Kashmir struggle in the Pakistani school curriculum.[15]

Pakistan made use of non-state proxies during two wars with India over Kashmir in 1947 and 1965, a practice detailed in Chapter 3. The army did so again during the civil war in 1971, deploying them against Bangladeshi separatists. Following that conflict, a number of Pakistan’s elected and martial governments continued to sponsor Islamist groups to serve internal and external political interests. Although these governments at times